Western Cape Government
FOR YOU

Wes-Kaapse Regering

Directorate: GET Curriculum
Direktoraat: Kurrikulum AOO

# BACK ON TRACK
# EXEMPLAR TASK 8
# RESPONSE TO LITERATURE MEMO

## ENGLISH - GRADE 7
## TERM 3-2025



Back on Track

TEAM READ
A DRIVE FOR ABSOLUTE LITERACY

# SCHOOL NAME

School Badge

## FORMAL ASSESSMENT TASK 8
## RESPONSE TO LITERATURE
## TERM 3

## ENGLISH HOME LANGUAGE
## GRADE 7
## 2025

**EDUCATOR: MS. / MR.** _____

**NAME & SURNAME:** _____

**GRADE:** _____

| FAT | QUESTION | TASK DESCRIPTION: | TIME | MARKS | | MARK ACHIEVED | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FAT 8 | 1 | Response to Literature: **Poem** | **45 min.** | **10** | **30** | | |
| | 2 | Response to Literature: Novel / **Drama** | **30 min.** | **10** | | | |
| | 3 | Response to Literature: **Short Story** / Folklore | **30 min.** | **10** | | | |
| | | | **TOTAL** | **30** | | | |

**Compiler:** WCED Back on Track **Date:** _____ **September 2025**

**Moderator:** **Ms. / Mr. X**

**Initial:** _____ **Date:** _____

**Departmental Head:** **Ms. / Mr. X**

**Initial:** _____ **Date:** _____

**Principal:** **Ms. / Mr. X**

**Initial:** _____ **Date:** _____

**Name:** .....
**Surname:** .....
**Date:** .....
**Moderator:** Ms. / Mr. X
**Initial:** .....

School Badge

**Grade 7** .....
**Compiler:** WCED Back on Track
**TOTAL: 10 marks in 45 minutes**
**Signature of Parent/Guardian:**
.....

**INSTRUCTIONS:**
1. This FAT, Task 8, consists of THREE questions.
2. This is question **ONE** of three.
3. Answer all the questions and take note of the mark allocation.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

| **Question 1 – Response to Literature: POEM** | **Mark achieved** | _____ / 10 |
|---|---|---|

**Read the following poem and answer the questions that follow.**

# Black and White by Ruth Everson

I was fatly five
When Johanna ascended her throne
In the kiadom of our backyard.
Raised on bricks she banished
The tokoloshe from my childhood
And as I grew sleek-
She grated and peeled her years away.

On 25cms of black and white she watched
The gloss of "The Bold and the Beautiful",
Moroka Swallows flew through goalless Saturdays.
She lined her cupboard with columns of print,
Black and white news of a world beyond.
Growing smaller in the flowered overall,
She washed and folded her years away.

She held my tears in the cracks of her hands,
She beamed my triumph through the gaps in her grin,
Hers was the voice that called me from play.
Joanna.Johanna.I cannot spell your name.
I don't know where they buried your smile.
But in the black and white backyard of my days,
The tokoloshe cavorts unrestrained.

**WORD BANK:**

**Kia/kya:** A South African word for an African hut or for a servant's quarters.

**Tokoloshe:** A South African word for a legendary evil spirit usually imagined to be in the form of a hairy, dwarfish man. An evil imp or goblin, active mainly at night.

**Cavorts:** jump or dance around excitedly

**Source:** https://www.thutong.doe.gov.za/ResourceDownload.aspx?id=40865&userid=-1

**1.1.** Who is the author of this poem? [1]

_____

**1.2.** Quote a phrase from the poem which tells us that the poet was a plump child. [1]

_____

**1.3.** Give one word from the poem which means the same as:

**1.3.1.** glowed with pride [1]

_____

**1.4.** Identify the figure of speech in the phrase:

"When Johanna ascended her throne." (line 2) [1]

_____

**1.5.** What does this phrase tell us about Johanna's appearance? [1]

_____

_____

**1.6.** How does the poet make the line "I cannot spell your name" (line 18) credible (convincing or believable)? [1]

_____

**1.7.** "She grated and peeled her years away." (Line 7)

"She washed and folded her years away." (line 14)

In your own words, explain the tasks that Johanna performed. [1]

_____

_____

**1.8.** Why do you think Johanna is referred to as "growing smaller"? (line 13) [2]

_____

**1.9.** Which is your favourite line from the poem? State why. [1]

_____

_____

**TOTAL:10 MARKS**

**Name:** .....
**Surname:** .....
**Date:** .....
**Moderator:** Ms. / Mr. X
**Initial:** .....

School Badge

**Grade 7** .....
**Compiler:** WCED Back on Track
**TOTAL: 10 marks in 30 minutes**
**Signature of Parent/Guardian:**
.....

**INSTRUCTIONS:**

1. This FAT, Task 8, consists of THREE questions.
2. This is question **TWO** of three.
3. Answer all the questions and take note of the mark allocation.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

| **Question 2 – RESPONSE TO LITERATURE: DRAMA** | **Mark achieved** | **_____ / 10** |
|---|---|---|

**Read the drama below and answer the questions that follow:**

**Summary:** A conversation between six friends about their weekend's events.

**Age group:** 12-13 year olds

**Characters:** Pradesh, Joe, Bridget, Anna, Busi and Sam

**Set:** Six friends sit in a semi-circle on one side of the stage. They are dressed comfortably. Certain friends' faces look like they're angry at the world. It is pretty sunny and the sounds of the birds come through clearly. Suddenly, the company between the six friends takes a sharp turn when the topic starts to dwell on money.

**Stage directions:** In italics and in brackets (...) in each speaking turn.

°°°°°°

**1. PRADESH:** (*Dejected*) What did you do this weekend, Joe?

**2. JOE:** (*Shows little interest*) Not much. I was so bored! There is nothing to do in our house. And we couldn't go anywhere. And you?

**3. PRADESH:** (*Looks down.*) I wanted to go to the beach to surf, but the weather was too bad.

**4. BRIDGET:** (*Excited.*) I love the rain. (*Shakes her hair.*) I went to the movies (*head in the light*) and spent the rest of the weekend with my nose in a book. (*Smiles broadly.*)

**5. ANNA:** Oh! I also love to read…

**6. PRADESH:** (*Annoyed*) ...no one asked you guys!!!

**7. BRIDGET:** Don't be ugly, Pradesh. What has made you all hot under the collar?

**8. PRADESH:** (*Calm*) Ah, ok! Sorry, guys. I'm just very annoyed that I can't do what I want to do on weekends...

**9. BUSI:** (*Interrupts Pradesh*.) Well... (*looks at Bridget and Anna*) I wanted to go to the movies too, but I couldn't get there. My dad and mom were too busy to take me.

(A CAR DRIVES BY)

**10. JOE:** (*Extends his arms*) You know, I like movies too, but I never have money. (*Shakes out his trouser pockets*)

**11. PRADESH:** Yes, I know exactly how you feel. Everything costs money these days. Money that a man doesn't have. (*Looks at Sam*) What did you do, Sam?

**12. SAM:** We organized a football match, but as you know it rained all weekend. (sigh) Then we all played computer games at one of our teammates' houses.

**13. ANNA:** Just think what we could do with money... (*interrupted by Pradesh*)

**14. PRADESH:** ...and our own wheels... (*Joe interrupts for Pradesh*.)

**15. JOE:** You need a license, dude!

**16. ANNA:** (*Anna sucks in air through her teeth*.) I wish I was big! ...we were big!

**17. BRIDGET:** Maybe we can do something about it.

**18. JOE:** (*Interested*) Yeah, but like what?

**19. BRIDGET:** (*Looks at everyone in the circle*.) Maybe we should put our heads together...

(EVERYONE STARTS TALKING AT THE SAME TIME...)

**20. BUSI:** (*Speaks louder than the others*!) S...sh...shshshsh! I have an idea. And don't laugh. (*Looks at Pradesh*) First listen carefully. What if we put together our own money - like a stokvel.

**21. PRADESH:** (*Unsure*) What is a stokvel?

(EVERYONE STARTS TALKING SIMULTANEOUSLY AGAIN...)

**22. SAM:** (*Excited*) I know! I know! I know! (*Takes a deep breath*.) It's like a kind of club where adults pool all their money. My father and mother belong to one and it is managed via Whatsapp. They pay an amount every month and each member gets a month in which they receive all the money.

**23. ANNA:** THAT'S A GOOD IDEA!!! (*Clap hands excitedly*.) We all just need enough data.

**24. BRIDGET:** (*Smiles broadly*.) And so we can finally all start doing things together as a group.

**25. SAM:** So, that's it, huh! We are in a stokvellllllllll!!!! (*Sits and dances with arms*.)

**26. ANNA:** Now we have to find a name.

**27. BRIDGET:** What about Secret Six? Or better yet,... Young Moolah Babies?

**28. ANNA:** Or what about... (*pretending to beat drums*) The Planners.

**29. BUSI:** Let's write a bunch of ideas on a piece of paper and then we'll vote for them.

**30. EVERYONE:** BUT WHERE ARE WE GOING TO GET THE MONEY???

**31. ANNA:** And daaatttaaaaaaa!!!

(THE SIX FRIENDS FINALLY CHOSE THE NAME, WEEKEND FUN CLUB.)

**Translated from and Source adapted:**

Brink, M., Conradie, N., Cornelissen, R., Cupido, R., Elias, L. & Spangenberg, H. Via Afrika Afrikaans Huistaal - Leerderboek. Via Afrika

2.1 Name any two (2) characters in the drama? (1x2)

Character 1 = _____ Character 2 = _____

2.2 What is the relationship between the characters? (1)

_____

2.3 What is the first stage direction found in the play? (1)

_____

2.4 What can you infer about the behaviour pattern of Pradesh during the first, third and eighth stage directions? (1)

_____

2.5 What does the following statement tell us about Bridget's relationship with books? (1)

| | |
|---|---|
| **4. BRIDGET:** | (*Excited*.) I love the rain. (*Shakes her hair*.) I went to the movies (*head in the light*) and spent the rest of the weekend with my nose in a book. (*Smiles broadly*.) |

_____

_____

2.6 What do you think might have kept Busi's parents busy? (1)

_____

_____

2.7 What do you suggest Busi should do next time to ensure that she does make it to the cinema? (HINT: A Cinema and a Bioscope are in the same WhatsApp group.) (1)

_____

_____

2.8 The characters are experiencing a problem. What would you do if you were in the same situation as the characters? (1)

_____

_____

2.9 Yes or No: Do you think the language used in this drama is suitable for the reader to understand what is happening in the flow of the storyline? Motivate. (1)

_____

_____

**TOTAL: 10 MARKS**

**Name:** .....
**Surname:** .....
**Date:** .....
**Moderator:** Ms. / Mr. X
**Initial:** .....

School Badge

**Grade 7** .....
**Compiler:** WCED Back on Track
**TOTAL: 10 marks in 30 minutes**
**Signature of Parent/Guardian:**
.....

**INSTRUCTIONS:**
1. This FAT, Task 8, consists of THREE questions.
2. This is question **THREE** of three.
3. Answer all the questions and take note of the mark allocation.
4. Write neatly and legibly.

| Question 3 – RESPONSE TO LITERATURE: SHORT STORY | Mark achieved | _____ / 10 |
|---|---|---|

**Read the extract below from a short story and answer the questions that follow.**

## I am sorry. by E.K.M. Dido

1. The two teenage boys sit hunched over with their hands limp between their outstretched legs on the cool, white marble stone. Every now and then one gives a heavy sigh. Another picks up a hand full of sharp, gray pebbles next to him, and lets them slip out of his hand one by one.

2. It's quiet and warm where they sit, but both of their white school shirts are buttoned up to the neck. Here and there the sun burns down on them through the leaves of an oak tree. A sunspot falls on one of the boys' dusty black school shoes; he slowly pulls his leg up and hugs his knee and sighs. In the tree branches far above them a pigeon coos. A sparrow floats out of the blue sky to the ground and sits and chirps on a marble slab not far from them. The boys don't pay attention to the sparrow. Nor do they pay attention to the distant rumble of car engines and trucks. They just sit , hunched over, on the marble stone.

3. "Old Dingo's new kaia looks funny now that the ground is level and the marble is up, eh bra Mike?" one breaks the silence.

4. "That's right, Charlie," replied Mike, turning his head sideways and looking at the headstone of the marble. His lips trembled slightly as he spoke again. "I'm really sorry, Dingo. You will never know how sorry! I never meant to drag you in. I..." He stopped talking and rubbed his hands together.

5. "I'm so sorry, my bra," Charlie said softly and picked up pebbles again and watched them fall from his hand one by one.

6. For a long time they sat still again. Each with their own thoughts. Then, as if reading each other's thoughts, they swung their heads towards the writing on the headstone, and began to read softly but clearly what was chiseled out in large, thick, black writing on the white marble:

**JOHN MATTHEW DINGO**

**2 Dec. 1988 - 24 Aug. 2005**

**"For a short time you were on loan to us, but forever we will remember you."**

7. “I'm really sorry, Dingo. I miss you terribly!” Mike said, then looked at Charlie. "Do you think old Dingo can hear us?" he asked.

Charlie doesn't answer right away. His eyes are shining and he first blows his nose on his left shirt sleeve. "I don't know, my bra," he answered with a shaky voice. "But I think so."

8. Mike's head jerked towards his friend. "Really?" he asked. His voice sounded hopeful. He took a quick look at the marble headstone and then looked at Charlie again.

9. "Yeah, I think bra Dingo can hear," repeated Charlie. "I was on a vibe once. Long before the stuff happened. That day I quickly took a few hits of tik with the men at the corner shop. I don't know where you and bra Dingo were because you weren't around..."

10. "Charlie, get to the point!" Mike interrupted him.

"Okay. sorry. Anyway, you know how that stuff gets me talking. Babbling non-stop, you know! I tell you my brother, I wanted to be silent, but my tongue was wagging so badly that no one could silence me. Back at home I had to shove chewing gum in my mouth to keep quiet. Because the aunty I was living with was checking me out funny, I felt obliged to sit next to her on the sofa and watch her programme. It was quite a church program!” he said with a touch of annoyance in his voice. His friend's mouth opened, but he continued to speak quickly. "Yes-no, as I say, there I sat in a lekker vibe next to the aunty, watching TV about a bunch of ministers who were arguing about dead people... sorry, bra Dingo," he quickly apologises to the headstone before he continues to speak.

11. But before he could say another word, Mike gave a loud sob and went to kneel by the headstone. His tears came quickly and streamed down his cheeks. "I'm sorry, Dingo. So sorry!”, he kept repeating through the sobs. When he calmed down, he rose from his knees and sat tightly against Charlie on the ridge of the marble headstone.

Mike looked straight ahead, without blinking. After a long time he asks again, without looking at Charlie: "What did the ministers have to say?"

“I miss him too, old Mike. We'll never find a pal like him again," comforts Charlie and puts an arm around his friend's shoulder.

"Yes, I miss him. The whole school and the whole community miss him. Things will never be the same without him, right?"…

***Translated. Text continued at*:** https://afrikaans-afrikaans.weebly.com/uploads/5/3/5/8/5358755/ek_is_jammer.pdf

3.1 Who are the two (2) characters in the story?

_____ (1x2)

3.2 Give one word to describe the emotional state of two characters in paragraph 2?

_____ (1)

3.3 Quote a sentence from paragraph 4 that tells us that Mike is getting emotional?

_____ (1)

3.4 What are the underlined words in paragraph 3 referring to?

_____

_____ (1)

3.5 What type of narrator is found here? Motivate your answer.

_____

_____

_____ (1x2)

3.6 What is the setting of the short story? Cite proof from paragraph 6.

_____

_____ (1)

3.7 In paragraphs 9 and 10, reference is made to the "vibe" that Charlie experienced. Why do you think the use of language in a short story is important? How does it make the reader feel?

_____

_____ (1)

3.8 What do you think is the message or theme in this extract from the short story?

_____

_____ (1)

**TOTAL: 10 MARKS**

**GRAND TOTAL: 30 MARKS**